SEIZURE WATCH - Weekly News Bulletin

Reporting week: Mon 26 October - Sun 1 November 2026 | Published Monday 2 November 2026, 10:00 (Brussels)

Top stories this week. Elephant ivory led the week: more than 3 tonnes seized at Thailand's Laem Chabang port, reportedly hidden in timber from Zambia. Europe saw a 4.5-tonne cocaine haul concealed in cheese in Leeds and a Malaga operation netting hashish and cocaine, while US cases ranged from meth lab takedowns to a 24-person Tennessee indictment. All 10 items are unverified and ranked by risk score.

1. Over 3 tonnes of ivory seized at Laem Chabang

Thai customs found elephant tusks and ivory, reported as hidden in timber from Zambia, at Laem Chabang port; two arrests reported. Reports cite about 3.0-3.1 tonnes. **(unverified)**

Thailand, Laem Chabang | Risk: High (85) | Bangkok Post / Thaiger

2. Almost five million illegal cigarettes seized at Manchester Airport

Four arrests after about 440 kg of cigarettes were intercepted; the route is linked to the United Arab Emirates. **(unverified)**

United Kingdom, Manchester | Risk: High (80) | fish4news

3. Sri Lanka steps up fight on transnational drug trade

Coverage of US-South Asia cooperation as Sri Lanka strengthens action against transnational drug trafficking; four arrests recorded. **(unverified)**

Sri Lanka, Colombo | Risk: High (80) | The Morning

4. Gang caught with 4.5 tonnes of cocaine hidden in blocks of cheese

Police in Leeds uncovered a gang smuggling roughly 4.5 tonnes of cocaine, valued by reports at GBP 450m, concealed in cheese; Canada is listed as origin. **(unverified)**

United Kingdom, Leeds | Risk: High (75) | The Sun

5. Spanish police hit organised crime: hashish and cocaine seized in Malaga

An operation reportedly netted 2.5 tonnes of hashish and 600 kg of cocaine, with eight arrests. **(unverified)**

Spain, Malaga | Risk: High (75) | 20Minutos

6. Doctor held at Port Miami with luggage of ecstasy and edibles

Police report a cruise passenger carrying ecstasy, psychedelic chocolates and marijuana edibles on a route via the Bahamas. **(unverified)**

United States, Miami | Risk: High (75) | WCTI

7. Kern County task force dismantles meth conversion labs

A months-long operation shut down several methamphetamine conversion labs; five arrests and about 971 kg of methamphetamine reported. **(unverified)**

United States, San Bernardino | Risk: High (75) | Bakersfield.com

8. 24 charged after large Tennessee methamphetamine seizure

A cartel-linked seizure of about 500 kg of methamphetamine led to federal charges against 24 people; Mexico is listed as origin. **(unverified)**

United States, Tennessee | Risk: High (75) | The UC Now

9. Tunisia's big cocaine cases, from the sea to Tunis-Carthage airport

A review of recent cocaine cases in Tunisia, including a seizure of about 75 kg, with a route from Libya. **(unverified)**

Tunisia, Tunis | Risk: High (75) | La Presse de Tunisie

10. Tests undercut claims of cocaine-soaked hardwood

Global tests reportedly found no support for claims of cocaine-impregnated timber linked to Peru (Callao). **(unverified)**

Peru, Callao | Risk: High (75) | Wood Central

Source: open-source news, automatically collected and risk-scored by Seizure Watch. Photos belong to the credited outlets and are shown as small thumbnails with a link to the original article. Unverified reports should be confirmed before operational use.